

# Teaching Evaluations: A Summary

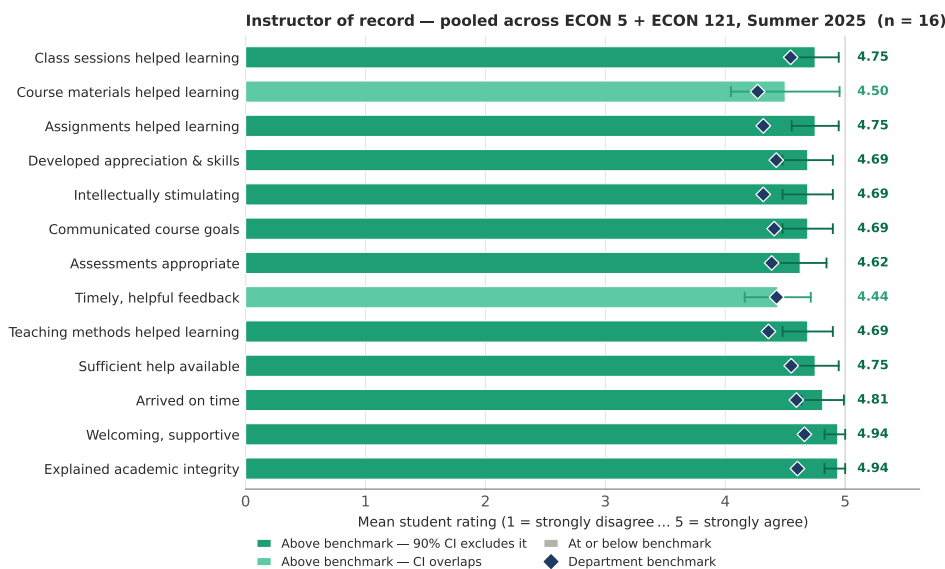
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Student ratings, 2022–2026 • instructor of record and teaching / instructional assistant

This note summarizes roughly **330 student evaluations** collected at UC San Diego between 2022 and 2026: two courses as **instructor of record** (ECON 5 and ECON 121, three sections,  $n = 32$ ) and sixteen discussion and lab sections as a **teaching / instructional assistant** ( $n \approx 296$ ), spanning ECON 5, ECON 100A, ECON 121, ECON 171, ECON 190, and GPEC 443. All ratings are on the standard five-point scale (5 = strongly agree). Bars show the mean, with a 90% confidence interval where per-response data are available; where a departmental comparison exists it is drawn as a navy diamond, and the bar is colored by whether the rating exceeds that benchmark (see the note at the end).

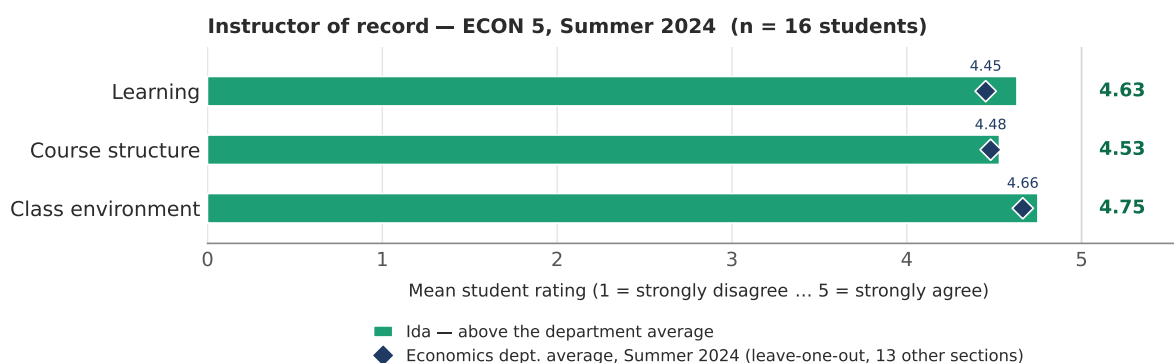
## Instructor of record

As instructor of record, Ida's ratings exceed the departmental benchmark on **every item**, and do so by a statistically meaningful margin (the 90% confidence interval clears the benchmark) on **11 of 13 items** when the two most recent courses are pooled (Figure 1). The benchmark is the mean across all Economics Summer-Session-I courses at the same level.



**Figure 1.** Instructor of record, pooled across ECON 5 and ECON 121 (Summer 2025,  $n = 16$ ). Green where the 90% CI excludes the departmental benchmark, light green where it overlaps; no item is at or below benchmark.

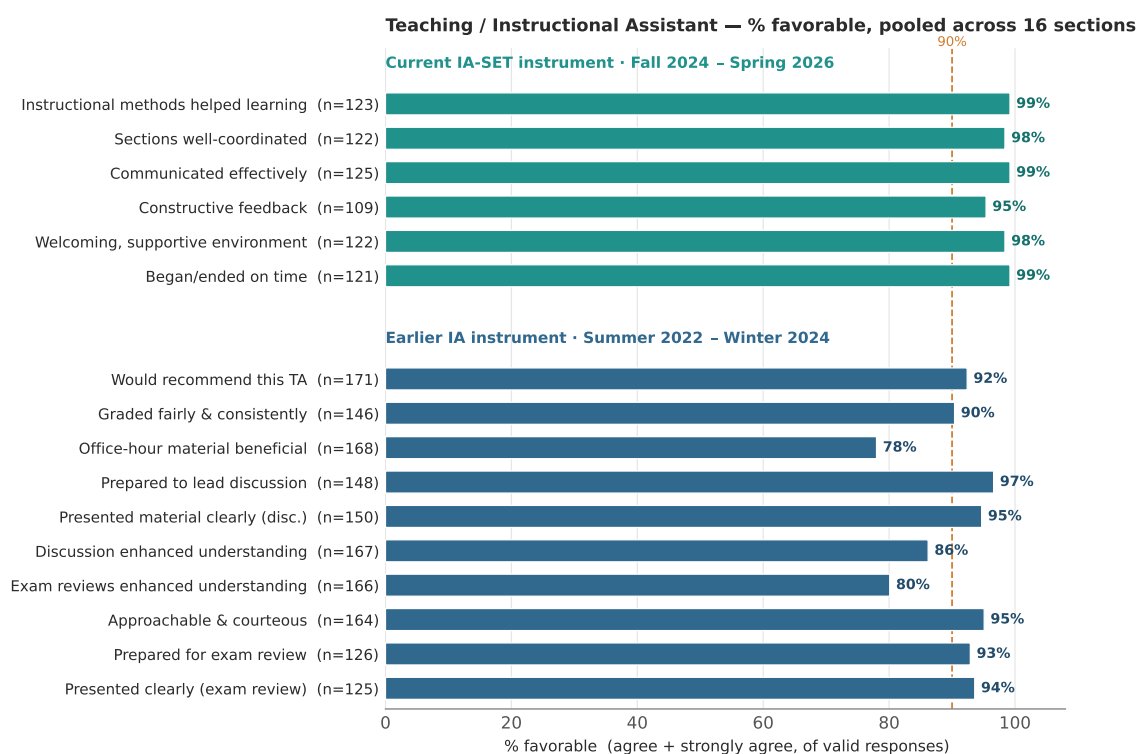
Her earlier course as instructor of record, ECON 5 in Summer 2024 (Figure 2), shows the same pattern. The 2024 SET report itself published no departmental comparison, so the benchmark here is reconstructed from the department's own SET records: the leave-one-out average of every other Economics Summer-Session-I section that term. At the level those records report, the three SET dimensions, Ida sits above the department on all three.



**Figure 2.** Instructor of record, ECON 5 (Summer 2024,  $n = 16$ ). Bars are Ida’s three SET dimension averages (each a composite of the related survey items); the navy diamond is the Summer-2024 Economics department average, leave-one-out (the mean of the 13 other Economics sections that term), reconstructed from the department’s own SET records because the 2024 report published no comparison.

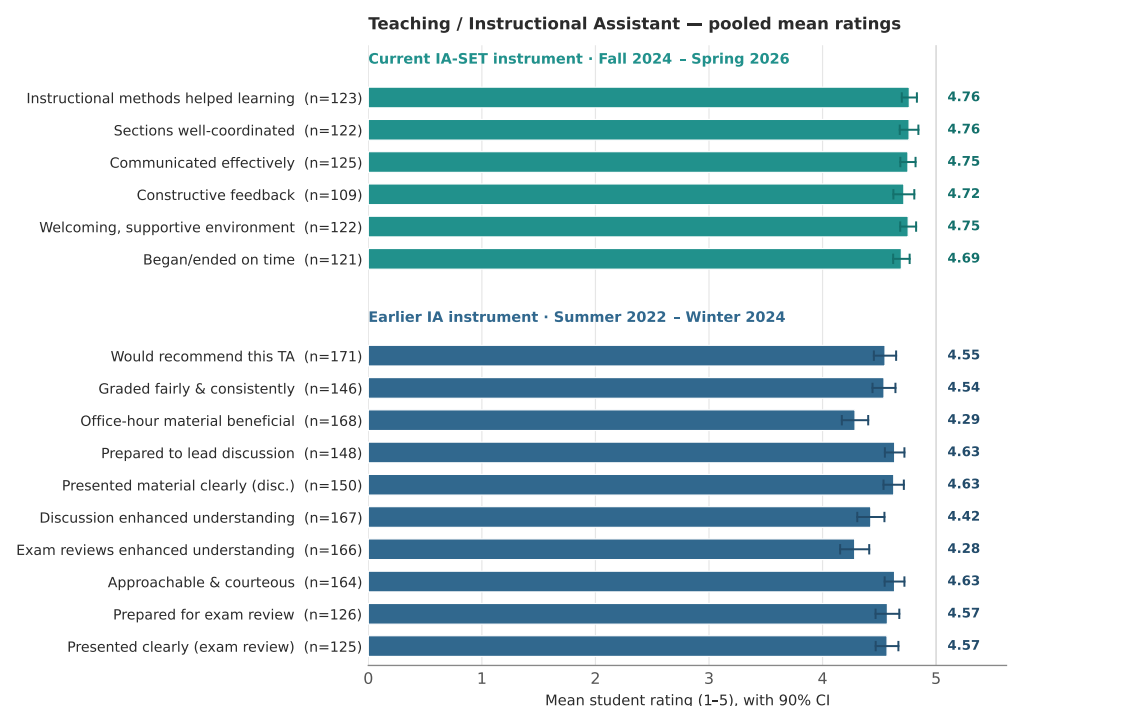
## Teaching and instructional assistant

Across sixteen TA and IA sections, student endorsement is high and stable. On the current instructional-assistant instrument (Fall 2024 onward), **95–99% of students** respond favorably on every item, including communication, a welcoming environment, and constructive feedback; on the earlier instrument, favorability ranges from 78% to 97%, with the lowest values on whether exam-review and office-hour sessions deepened understanding (Figure 3). The mean ratings tell the same story (Figure 4), with tight intervals reflecting the large pooled samples ( $n$  up to 171 per item).



Teal = the current IA-SET instrument; blue = the earlier instrument (its items differ, so the two are pooled separately).  $n$  = pooled valid responses per item.

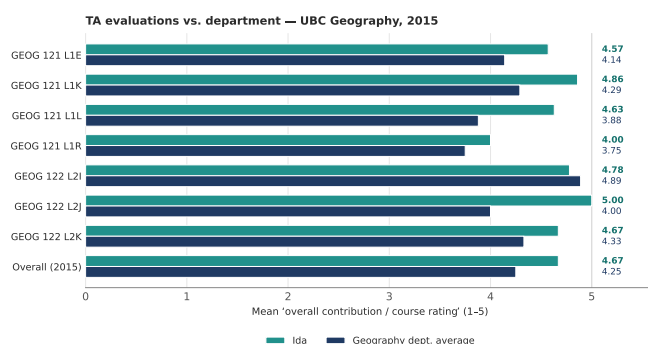
**Figure 3.** Share of students responding favorably (agree or strongly agree), pooled across all TA/IA sections. Teal = the current IA-SET instrument; blue = the earlier instrument, whose items differ.



Teal = current IA-SET instrument; blue = earlier instrument. UCSD publishes no departmental benchmark for IA evaluations (see the UBC figure for the one external comparison). Whisker = 90% t-CI.

**Figure 4.** Pooled mean ratings with 90% confidence intervals, by instrument.

UC San Diego does not publish a departmental benchmark for instructional-assistant evaluations, so the TA figures above stand on their own. The one TA evaluation in the record that *does* carry a departmental comparison is from an earlier role at the University of British Columbia (Figure 5): across seven Geography sections in 2015, Ida’s “overall contribution / course rating” averaged **4.67** against the department’s **4.25**, above the department in six of the seven sections.

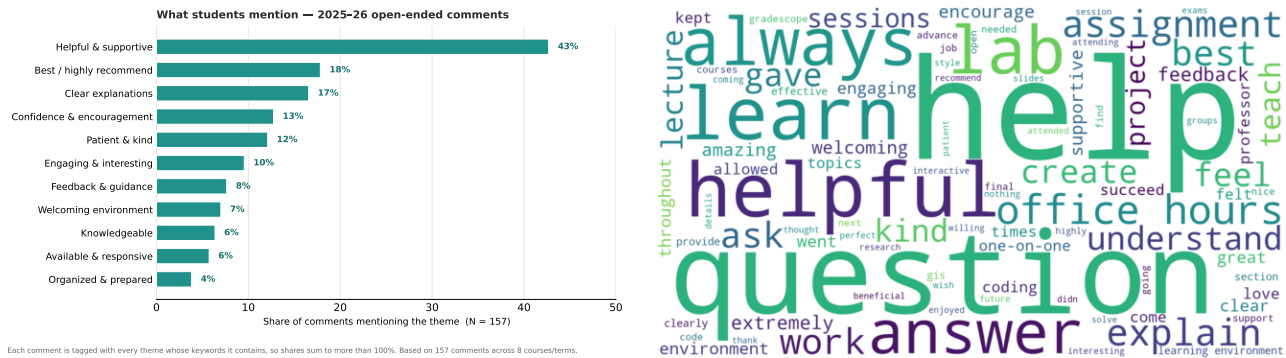


The only TA evaluation in the record that carries a departmental comparison. Across seven sections her rating averaged 4.67 vs. the department's 4.25, above the department in six of seven sections. (Different institution, instrument, and era from the UCSD figures.)

**Figure 5.** TA ratings vs. the Geography department average, UBC 2015. A different institution, instrument, and era, included as the only available TA-versus-department comparison.

## In students' words

The open-ended comments from 2025–2026 were tagged by theme: nearly half mention how **helpful and supportive** she is, and the next most common themes are clear explanations, encouragement that builds confidence, and patience and kindness (Figure 6). The most frequent individual words echo this (Figure 3).



**Figure 6.** Left: share of 157 open-ended comments (2025–26) mentioning each theme; a comment can match several. Right: the most frequent words after merging inflections (help/helped) and folding phrases (“office hours”), with distinctive adjectives such as “helpful” kept separate.

A few representative comments:

*Ida was wonderful throughout the summer session; she helped answer every question I had and made class interesting. (ECON 5, instructor of record, Summer 2025)*

*Very interesting and engaging; [she] kept me interested in a subject I was not previously interested in. (ECON 121, instructor of record, Summer 2025)*

*When I first met her, I thought she was already a professor, that's how professional and engaging she was. She is an extremely effective teacher. (GPEC 443 (GIS & Spatial Data Analysis), TA, Fall 2025)*

*I came into this class very nervous, and I doubted my ability to succeed. Ida was one of the first people to make me feel like I can actually do GIS. (GPEC 443, TA, Fall 2025)*

*Talking through my ideas was extremely helpful in refining my research question; you've really pushed me to think further each meeting. (ECON 190 (Intro to Research in Economics), TA, Winter 2025)*

*Love her discussion section: very well organized, effective, and engaging. She's also very helpful!* (ECON 5, TA, Spring 2026)

**Notes.** *Sources:* UC San Diego official Student Evaluation of Teaching (SET) and Instructional-Assistant evaluation reports and their per-response data exports, 2022–2026, plus the UBC Geography TA report (2015). *Statistics:* bars are means on the 1–5 scale; whiskers are 90% *t*-confidence intervals ( $df = n - 1$ ), with the upper whisker capped at the scale ceiling of 5.0. “Favorable” counts *agree* and *strongly agree* among valid (non–“not applicable”) responses. *Color rule (instructor figures):* green = mean above benchmark and the 90% CI lower bound also above it; light green = mean above benchmark but the CI overlaps it; gray = at or below benchmark; the CI whisker and the printed value share each bar’s color. *Benchmarks:* the two Summer-2025 instructor reports publish a per-item departmental comparison; for ECON 5 (Summer 2024), whose report published none, the comparison is the Economics Summer-Session-I department average that term (leave-one-out, i.e. all other Econ sections), reconstructed from the department’s own SET records (every Economics section, extracted from the campus SET system) and shown at the three SET-dimension composites, the finest level those records report. No UCSD TA/IA report publishes a comparison. *Comments:* themes are keyword-tagged on 157 de-duplicated 2025–26 comments; the figures and all underlying data are reproducible from [teaching\\_evals/src/](https://teaching_evals/src/).